How the hazard perception test works

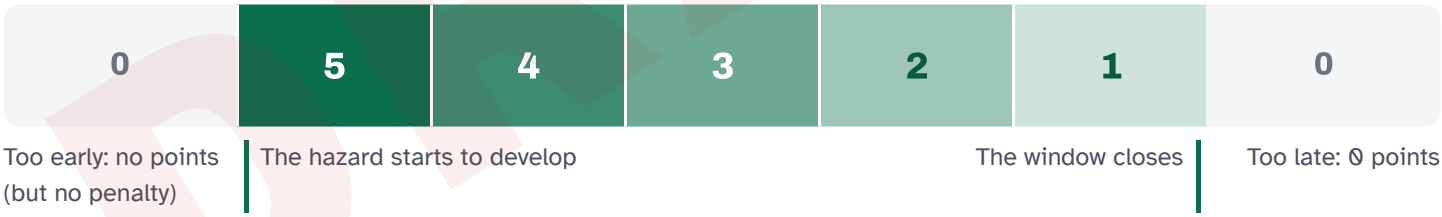
The second part of the theory test is a video test. You watch clips filmed from a driver's point of view and click when you see a hazard developing. The earlier you click once it starts to develop, the more points you score.

14	15	5	44/75
video clips	developing hazards to score	points maximum per hazard	to pass

THE RULES THAT DECIDE YOUR SCORE

- Every clip has at least one developing hazard. One clip has two.
- A developing hazard is something that would make you take action, like changing speed or direction.
- You score up to 5 points for each developing hazard: the sooner you click as it develops, the higher the score.
- You don't lose points for a click that turns out to be wrong.
- Click continuously or in a pattern and you score nothing for that clip.
- You have to pass both parts, multiple choice and hazard perception, to pass the theory test.

THE SCORING WINDOW



DRAFT

Spot it early: where developing hazards come from

Most hazards give you a clue before they develop. Train yourself to notice the clue, then click when it turns into something you would have to react to.

CLUE → CLICK

Parked cars

Clue: a car with someone inside, wheels turned or lights on. Click when it starts to pull out or a door opens.

Pedestrians near the kerb

Clue: someone looking to cross, a child near a ball, a bus stop. Click when they step towards the road.

Junctions and side roads

Clue: a vehicle waiting to emerge. Click when it starts to move out into your path.

Cyclists and motorcyclists

Clue: a rider looking over their shoulder or a parked car ahead of them. Click when they move out.

Traffic ahead

Clue: brake lights, a queue, a bus at a stop. Click when the vehicle ahead slows or pulls out.

Bends, hills and blind spots

Clue: you can't see far ahead. Click when something appears that makes you slow down.

Weather and darkness

Clue: rain, fog, low sun or night. Hazards appear later, so stay ready to click.

Horses and animals

Clue: a rider or animals near the road. Click when you need to slow down or give them room.

Potential vs developing

A parked car is a potential hazard: nothing to react to yet. It becomes a developing hazard when it starts to pull out. Clicking on the potential hazard won't cost you points, but make sure you click again as it develops.

DRAFT

Clicking without losing points

DO

- Click as soon as you see a hazard starting to develop.
- If you're not sure the window has opened, click again a moment later as it develops.
- Keep scanning the whole screen: mirrors, pavements, side roads and far ahead.
- Treat every clip as new: one clip has two hazards to find.

DON'T

- Don't click continuously or in a steady rhythm: that clip scores zero.
- Don't wait until the hazard is right in front of you: late clicks score less or nothing.
- Don't panic after a wrong click: it doesn't cost you points.
- Don't rush in on the first clue: a potential hazard alone isn't the developing one.

PRACTICE ROUTINE FOR THE WEEK BEFORE YOUR TEST

- [ ] Do a set of practice clips every day and note where you clicked late.
- [ ] On lessons, describe out loud the hazards you see as you drive.
- [ ] Re-read the vulnerable road users and hazard awareness maps.
- [ ] Do one full practice run of both parts of the test in one sitting.

> ⚠ **Remember**
> Hazard perception is a skill you build by watching clips. This guide explains the scoring and what to look for; pair it with practice clips before your test.

DRAFT

SOURCES GOV.UK, Theory test: hazard perception test